



Marred in controversy: India is scheduled to take on Pakistan at the T20 World Cup in Colombo on February 15. PTI

Chakaravarthy's googly.

Way before last year's Champions Trophy, Australia had refused during the ICC World Cup in 1996 to play in Sri Lanka because of the indiscriminate bombings that were happening there, which was understandable.

Then, in the 2003 World Cup, England refused to play in Zimbabwe, perhaps because they did not like the face of the then President Robert Mugabe announcing his policies.

What a silly excuse. There was no security threat to them or anything, yet they chose to stay away and forfeit their points. Did the ICC do anything? No. Because at that stage, the English and Australian boards ruled the roost, and the others did

not want to upset them.

There is a huge difference between a security threat as assessed by an independent commission, and simply not liking the policies of the government of another country.

But isn't this the old reasoning? Whenever umpires in the sub-continent made mistakes, it was 'cheating', while if similar mistakes were made by umpires from the old powers, then it was merely human error.

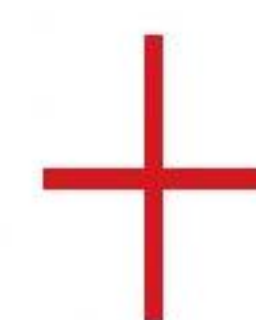
Similarly, pitches which have trampoline bounce and are dangerous to batters' safety are excused by saying the curator got his weather forecast wrong and left more grass on the pitch. Meanwhile, pitches in the sub-continent which

afford turn, and are only injurious to a batsman's reputation, are called dustbowls and what not.

The hypocrisy is striking, just as it is now. Even their representative in the ICC voted against Bangladesh, but the blame is only on the BCCI as the bully.

In the just-concluded final of the ICC Under-19 World Cup, Vaibhav Suryavanshi smashed 175 off only 80 balls against England and single-handedly took the game away from his opponents. To England's credit, they responded well and also got to 311 in reply to the Indian colts' 411.

Now, what young Suryavanshi did is bullying, and not the imaginary kind that some jaundiced people see.



We were told by many distinguished people connected with Pakistan cricket and politics that they had decided they were not going to be bullied by India. Hence, the decision not to play India. Only they can explain how India bullies other nations into voting with them.